

The Personality of Jesus Christ

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Perhaps Jesus Christ is our Benevolent Saviour, or that he is the Son of God and of Man; or perhaps he is the resplendent superstar of all ages, or that he is the King Psychotic of Heaven - I do not know, and I think nobody do. They are mere hypotheses in the sundries of weird hypotheses. Some 'salt and light' in the world claim that He is the Messiah through whom God reconciled the world to Himself. Other flocks of 'Black Sheep' stipulate that Christ was either a genius or a psychotic. Still some 'partisans' postulate that he was some extra-terrestrial intelligence. Nothing is more pestering - which of them is true? No one should attempt to answer it, but every person, I mean every human being, is entitled the right to propose every plausible hypothesis to account for the identity and deeds of Jesus Christ. Each of these hypotheses may be 'true'. Say, to see the Truth as it is and as it was, we shall wait for the Last Judgement.

The methodology I employ in the analysis of the personality of Jesus springs from the reconstruction of the life of Christ from the Biblical account, which is, as far as I know, the most complete historical and factual source of the biography of him. At least, the Bible is said to be the inspired words of God. However, the interpretations of it are another matter - even different disciples of the same sect (or denomination) have different interpretations, speak less among different branches of Christianity. After all, there is a prevailing confusion between representing symbols (the words of the Bible) and reality (the events actually occurred). Many devout believers tend to mistake language as reality and dwell upon their equivalence, no matter how the objective reality is contrary to it. Consequently, words cannot be taken at their face value and there exists an incongruence between symbols and the real world. This confusion also finds its breeding ground in various schools of philosophy as in positivism and idealism. One of the results of it is mystification of language. It usually assumes various mysteries in human religion, of which 'Trinity' in Christianity is an instance. Thus, the confusion resembles somewhat as childhood fantasy in which prototaxic and parataxic interactions are dominant.

The analysis of the psychopathology of Jesus Christ will

be executed in an eclectic approach, which, I think, is the best and the only best way in gaining insight into the experiential structure and emotional structure of Jesus in particular, and every human being in general.

To label hypothetically that Jesus Christ as a schizophrenic may well deserve eternal damnation where there is grinding of teeth. Yet, I can only admit that I give this label almost unreservedly. The symptomatology of Jesus as a process schizophrenic can be traced back to his childhood, when his parents found him in the Temple in Jerusalem. He just gave an inappropriate response when they saw him and inquired about his absence, (He answered them, 'Why did you have to look for me? Didn't you know that I had to be in my Father's house?' Lk 2:49) thus leaving his parents perplexed. The onset of his psychotic reaction began with his hallucinations and delusions. There are ample references in the Bible - The Temptation of Jesus as seen in Mt 4: 1-11; The Baptism of Jesus (Lk 3:21, 22); and when Jesus spoke about his death (Jn 12:27-35). These groups of massive auditory and visual hallucinations were acted out in virtue of his delusional system of thoughts. His delusions of persecution and grandeur culminated in his own claim as the Son of God and the Messiah who redeemed mankind through his crucifixion and resurrection (Jn 4:26; 5:24-29; 10:7-17; 12:27, 30, 44-50). Verbal and affective disorders were predominant. They could be reflected in the teachings, parables and the ordinary interactions of Christ with others. There are numerous instances in which he gave inappropriate and tangential reply to questions. I believe that these responses originated from his autistic preoccupation. Examples included the various parables, the various speeches of Jesus before the people (Jn 6:25-70; 15:1-10; Mk 10:18). The death of Jesus, as I believe it, was also a self-fulfilled prophecy through which he could act out his paranoid tendencies. The etiology of Jesus as a chronic paranoid schizophrenic may possibly be rooted in early awkward familial interactions. Besides, it is not surprising to see that the mother of Jesus, Mary, showed symptoms of psychosis. The lavish hope that Jesus would be the Son of God was much cherished by Mary when Jesus was still a foetus. (Lk 1:26-56). As a result, she might rear up Jesus as if he were the Saviour. Her distorted form of interactions with her child would eventually make Jesus believe that he himself was the Messiah.

Christianity has its appeal in the mass for they can satisfy the emotional needs of the regressive fixations and syndromes in the developmental stages of human beings. It is, by and large, a way of resolving critical issues of life experiences at the infantile level. Autonomy and rationality are relinquished to purchase the feeling of ultimate security. Thus, the believer erects a fata morgana for himself and abides in it, maintaining that it is the absolute reality. Jesus was dead, but his believers still participate in his life. The 'ghost' of Christ still haunts their hearts. Yet, these forms of religious experiences are those of the psychotic. Perhaps when you believe in Christ, you can inherit eternal psychotic life, or perhaps when you deny him, you will be doomed to the transient, painful hell of self-awareness.